

70.5 per cent

Two categories - Real-Time Entertainment and Web Browsing, represent 70.5% of all downstream traffic in Asia-Pacific. Averaged over 24 hours, Real-Time Entertainment is the dominant downstream application category, accounting for 43.6% of downstream bytes. While Web Browsing comes in Runners-Up.



Browser Wars

Browser wars are perhaps as old as the web itself. We have come a long way from the blocky prototype on NeXT to the current streamlined versions which use hardware

acceleration, snappy JavaScript engines and fast re-flow engines. And at the same time follow standards and recommendations laid out by W3C (surprising for a certain browser which always made a point to deviate in nearly all its previous versions). With the advent of HTML5 and CSS3 websites now behave like desktop applications, all browsers in some way or other support Web Apps. As far as market shares go, IE leads the pack with 39% followed by Firefox at 25% and Google Chrome at 21%, rest is shared by Opera, Safari and mobile browsers. But Google Chrome wins hands down as far as performance is concerned followed closely by Firefox.



Anonymous

How do you define something that is global, anarchic, amorphous, vindictive and bordering on psychopathy?

Anonymous is each of these things and much more. Anonymous is centered around the philosophy of trolling, which means purposefully antagonizing people which according to Anonymous is "getting inside someone's head so they leave the Internet for ever". But scales and dynamics have now changed it has grown from bullying people on forums and imageboards; to compromising causing global unrest. (Check out the interactive timeline: <http://goo.gl/VzBnT>) They say that they do this for the lulz. Even Law-enforcement agencies are finding it difficult to contain Anonymous. Logic or the lack of logic behind these acts is difficult to discern - too many social and psychological factors are involved.



Kevin Rosse

Kevin Rosse is one interesting individual - he's like the Paris Hilton of the web. He started off as the founder of Digg, and is currently its 'Chief Architect'. He also hosts a show "The Screensavers" on TechTV. Apart from this he has invested a lot in other successful companies. He is an example of a new breed of serial entrepreneurs who penetrate and exploit that most exclusive of social networks, the ranks of Silicon Valley's once and future promising personalities.



What runs the Internet?

First to come up are the Tier-1 networks which reside much closer to the backbone of the Internet and have peering arrangements among themselves sharing data among themselves, followed by Tier-2 networks which have peering agreements among themselves but still require transit at certain points in the network. It is from here that our ISPs enter the Internet. And then there are the root name servers, which convert human-readable addresses to IP addresses, there are 13 such servers present across the United States. They are controlled by ICANN is the authority for domain names, and also manages the IPv4 and IPv6 name spaces. It is primarily in place to maintain operational stability, manage day-to-day operations and nurture competition. Apart from these there are the millions of routers, switches, proxies and servers that propel this behemoth.



No Platform, No Worries

Web runs everywhere and anywhere, from super-computers to hand-held devices everything can access web. Perhaps logical step that the Internet can take is become the platform itself. This sounds a bit far-fetched and we seem to be a bit out of our depth but we kid you not. Ofcourse by platform here we mean a base on which something else can be built. Work has already begun in this direction, there is the Boot2Gecko Project started by the Mozilla Foundation which is trying and building an OS ground up using open web technologies. Then there are projects like Webian, Chromeless, Chromium OS and Web Intents which redefine the manner in which we perceive and use the web. Think of this as your entire OS running natively inside the browser.



Deep sea cables

You don't really think of them until a ship's anchor breaks one of them, but deep sea cables are what keep us connected via the net. They handle a whopping 99 per cent of world information traffic (satellites are responsible for the remaining 1%). Each cable supports a bandwidth of 7.1 terabits per second. Laying and maintaining these cables costs several hundred million dollars. India is connected to the world by 13 such underwater cables.



XXX

If you didn't catch the drift by now, you are better off skipping this section. In spite of being a taboo subject, Porn is considered to be one of the many reasons that has made the Internet what it is now. Porn sites get about 28,258 views every second. The industry in its entirety is worth about \$4.9 billion, and the entire world is fixated on getting vicarious pleasure. An estimated 12 per cent of all web sites on the Internet are pornographic. Currently, a debate rages over whether they should operate solely on the .xxx domain, thus making it easier to block and protect young children from porn. Whatever TLD is chosen, porn is not going anywhere!